

Monetize your Android app the right way

Perttu Lähteenlahti



AGENDA

- Why monetization is hard
- Options for Android
 - Ads, consumables, subscriptions, virtual currencies
- Why RC
- Using the SDK
 - Initializing
 - Paywalls
 - Entitlements and offerings
- Web billing

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Senior developer advocate at RevenueCat

- Carpentry -> cognitive science -> design
-> coding -> developer advocacy
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Why monetization is hard

developer got greedy and made
features that used to be free paid

★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Sep 18

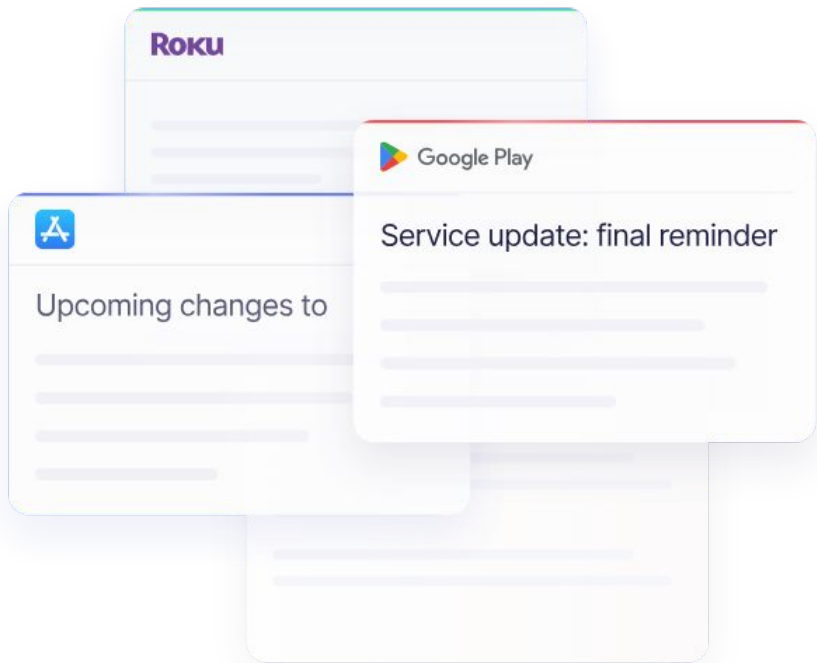


Swift Dev

@SwiftDev_UI · Follow

The Pain Points

1. Backend complexity (receipt validation, refunds, subscription state).
2. Multiple platforms to support (Android, iOS, web).
3. Regulatory changes and billing requirements.



Top 5% of apps earn 400× more than the bottom 25%" → **most apps get it wrong.**

1. Trial Start Rate (Median): App Store users start trials almost 2x as often as Google Play users
2. Download-to-Paid Conversion (Day 35): App Store apps convert at ~5%, while Google Play sits closer to 2.5%
3. Revenue Per Install (60 Days): iOS generates \$0.69 per install vs. Android's \$0.24—nearly 3x higher monetization
4. Payer Retention (1 Year): Interestingly, Android edges out iOS here—11.5% of payers retained vs. 9.2% on iOS

State of Subscription Apps
2025 report.

Options for Android

Monetization Models

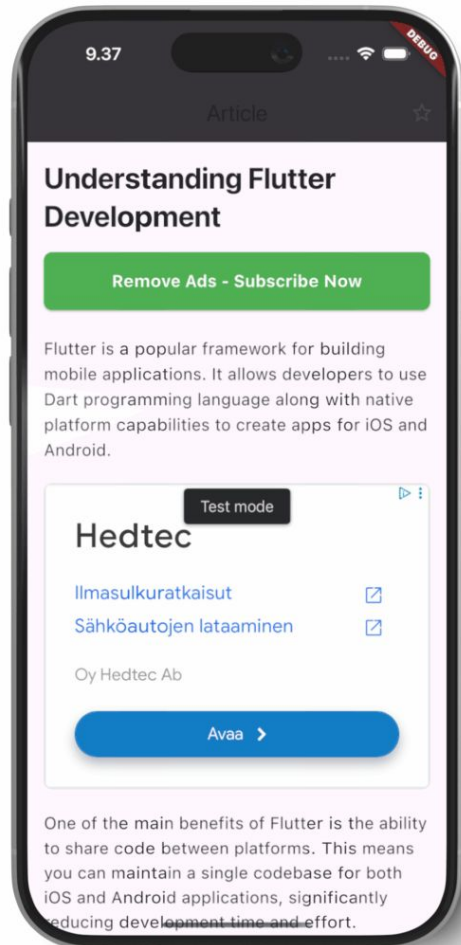
1. Putting a price on your app
2. Ads
3. Consumables
4. Non-consumables
5. Subscriptions
6. Virtual currencies

Monetization Models

- ~~1. Putting a price on your app~~
2. Ads
3. Consumables
- ~~4. Non-consumables~~
5. Subscriptions
6. Virtual currencies

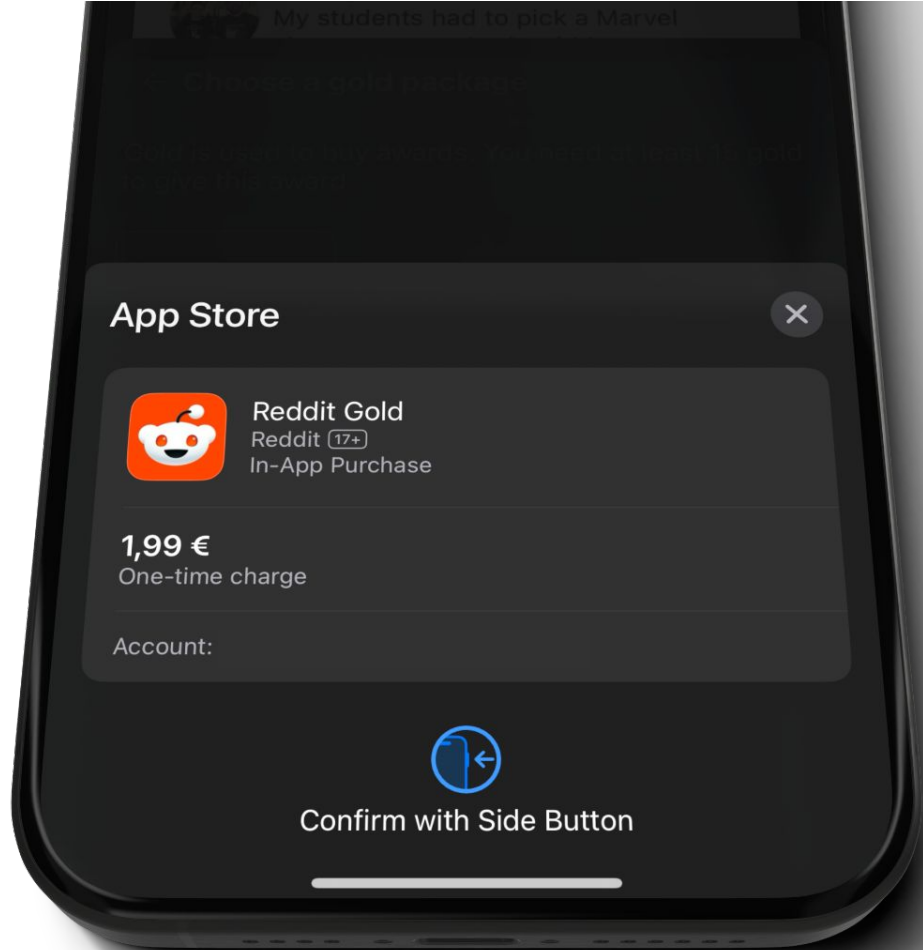
Ads: Monetization at Scale

- Best for apps with large free user bases
- Easy to implement, works in many categories
- But: lower LTV per user, needs high volume
- Common in casual games, media, free utilities



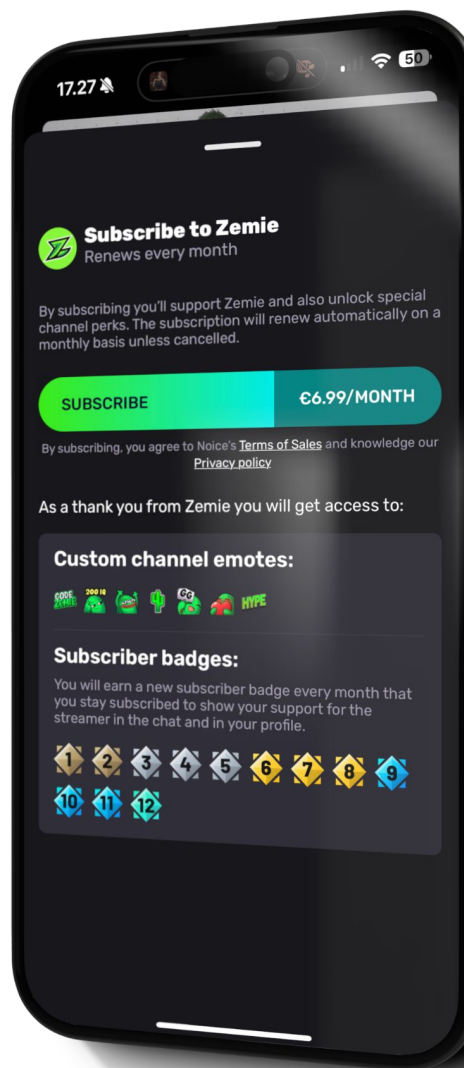
Consumables: Pay as You Go

- One-time use purchases (coins, credits, boosts)
- Common in games and utility apps (e.g., extra storage, tokens)
- Flexible and user-friendly entry point
- But: revenue depends on repeat buying



Subscriptions: Recurring Revenue

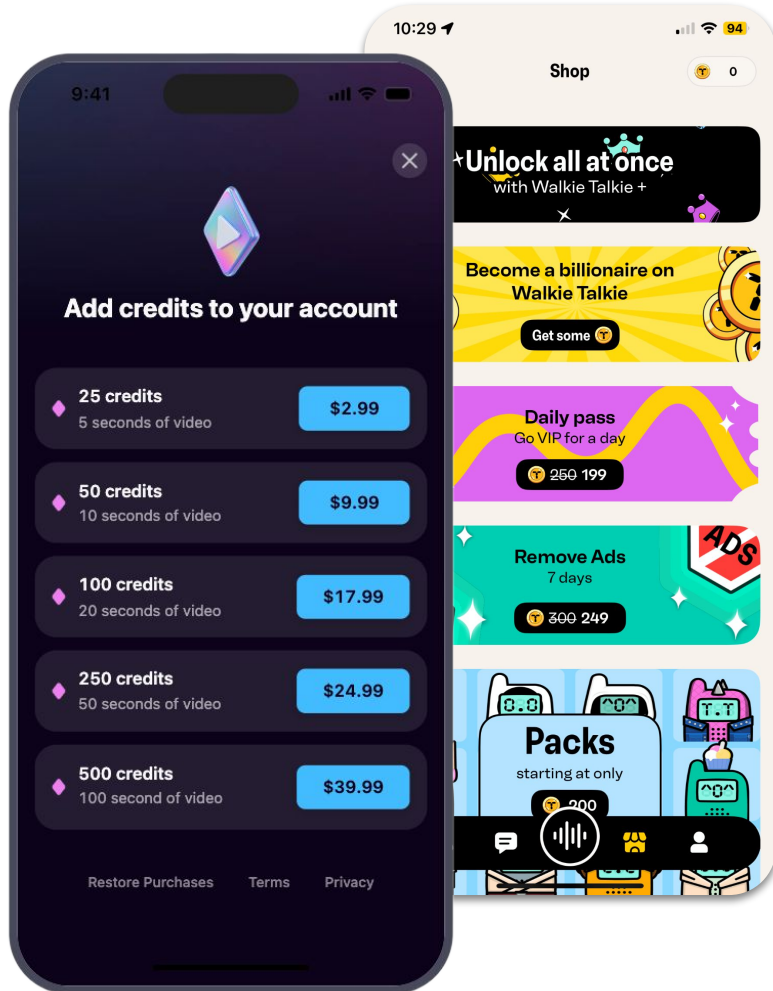
- Great for **productivity, lifestyle, and SaaS apps**
- Predictable income & stronger user commitment
- Supports free trials, intro offers, regional pricing
- **Churn risk:** must deliver ongoing value



Virtual currencies

Virtual currencies are digital assets used within your app to facilitate transactions

- Tokens/credits purchased via IAP
- Users spend flexibly on features/content
- Examples: Duolingo Gems, game currencies, LLM monetization

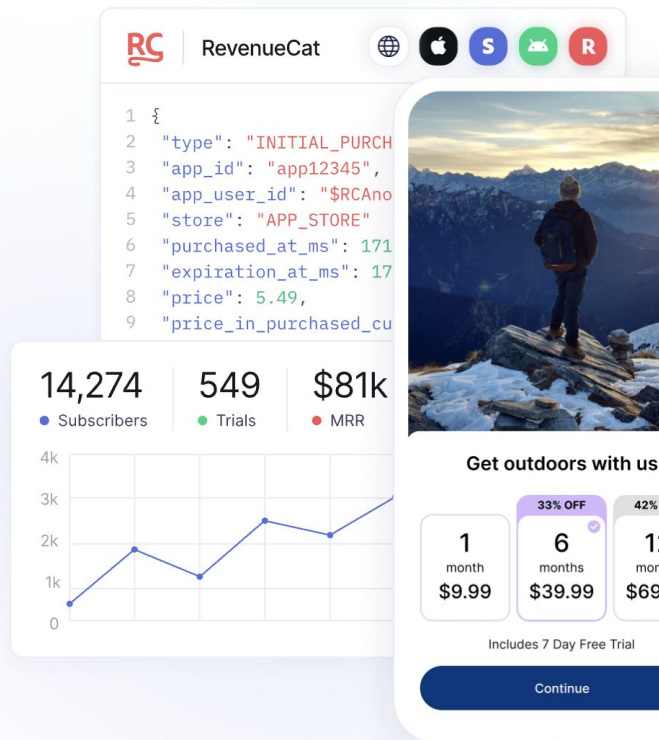


Why RevenueCat

RevenueCat Overview

Why you should not build it yourself

- Works with Kotlin and Flutter (and a bunch of other things)
- Handles store quirks & validation
- Paywall editor, experiments, analytics etc goodies
- Free until \$2.5k a month, after that 1% of the revenue you make through in-app purchases



Overview

Charts

Customers

Product catalog

Paywalls

Targeting

Experiments

Customer center

Apps & providers

API keys

Integrations

Project settings

Overview

Active Trials



43

In total ⓘ



Active Subscriptions



3,057

In total ⓘ



MRR



\$28,989

Monthly Recurring Revenue ⓘ



Revenue

\$

\$36,069

Last 28 days ⓘ



New Customers



7,400

Last 28 days ⓘ



Active Customers



18,407

Last 28 days ⓘ



Recent transactions

☐ Sandbox data

Customer ID	Store	Product	Purchased	Expires	Revenue	Type
c361b36c8b624714a01ee3e2b25340b3	Play Store	android_monthly	9 minutes ago	in a month	\$9.99	NEW SUB
9b64ee0e62af41678a3e0fc7524db772	App Store	ios_premium_monthly_1	11 minutes ago	in a month	\$9.99	RENEWAL
d266bcb342dd4001953c3def6224f236	App Store	ios_premium_monthly_1	14 minutes ago	in a month	\$9.99	RENEWAL
61da863abd1c4df998138ba1554d3711	App Store	ios_premium_monthly_1	31 minutes ago	in a month	\$9.99	RENEWAL
00dfddc940c54a588d28fb786dca19c8	App Store	ios_premium_monthly_1	an hour ago	in a month	\$9.99	RENEWAL
a2014459fd2727db41fb700bc2e7a2b	App Store	ios_premium_monthly_1	an hour ago	in a month	\$9.99	RENEWAL

Working with the SDK

Purchasing with RevenueCat



Initialize SDK

- At app start
- Identify customer



Purchase a subscription

- Paywalls
- Offerings
- Restore purchases



Grant access to content

- Entitlements

Initializing the SDK

```
class MainApplication: Application() {  
    override fun onCreate() {  
        super.onCreate()  
        Purchases.debugLogsEnabled = true  
        Purchases.configure(PurchasesConfiguration.Builder(this, <public_google_api_key>).build())  
    }  
}
```

Identifying Customers

How RevenueCat handles user identity

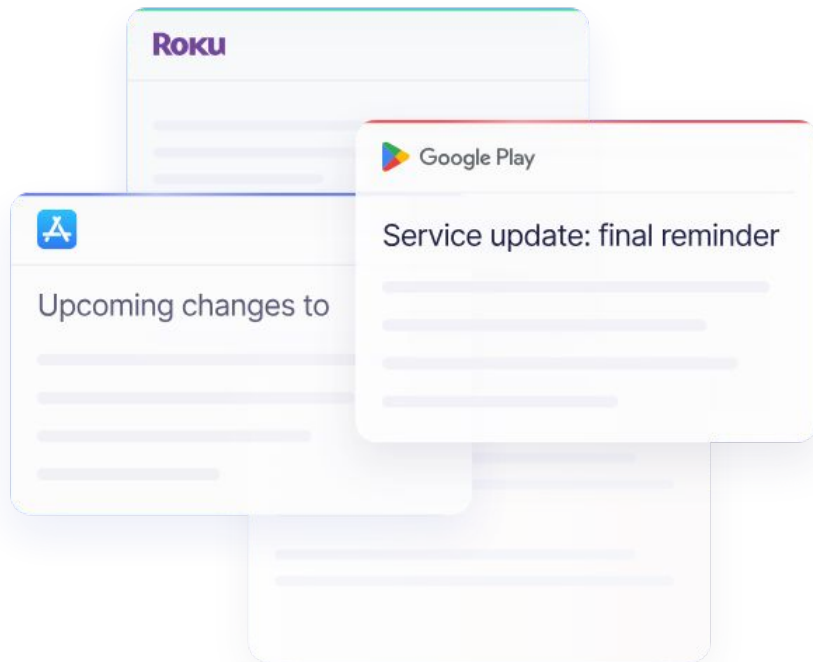
```
// Anonymous ID
Purchases.configure(PurchasesConfiguration.Builder(this, <api_key>).build())

// App user ID
Purchases.configure(PurchasesConfiguration.Builder(this, <api_key>).appUserID(<my_app_user_id>).build())
```

Purchasing with RevenueCat

Important terms

1. **Products**
Subscriptions, consumables
2. **Offerings**
Grouping products
3. **Paywalls**
Restrict access unless 💰
4. **Entitlements**
what user is eligible for

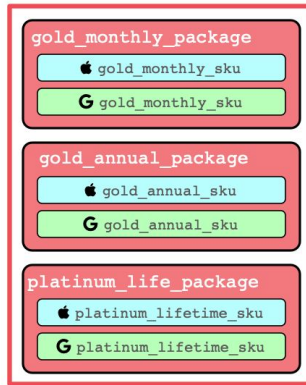


Offerings

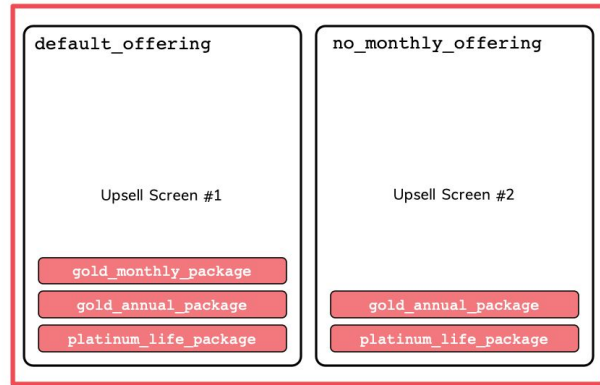
What Are Offerings?

- Group your products into packages (monthly, annual, lifetime, consumable).
- Define multiple offerings for the same entitlement.
- Example: Basic Offering (Monthly + Annual) vs Promo Offering (Free Trial + Annual Discount).
- A/B testing

RevenueCat Packages
(groups of equivalent store SKUs)



RevenueCat Offerings
(packages offered on payroll)



Paywalls

Purchasing: what are paywalls

- Offer different subscription options and trials
- Customize design and content for various segments
- A/B test pricing, copy, and visuals
- Track performance with analytics and integrations



our journey

nd and support you've been
king for.

meditation
reminders
t community

☒ Annual Full access for just \$69.99/yr	☐ Lifetime \$119.99
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Join to unlock our complete recipe book

- ✓ Thousands of curated recipes
- ✓ A vibrant, private community
- ✓ Priority support

☒ Annual Full access for just \$69.99/yr	19% OFF
--	---------

☐ Monthly Full access for just \$9.99/mo

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Restore purchases



Experience Pro too

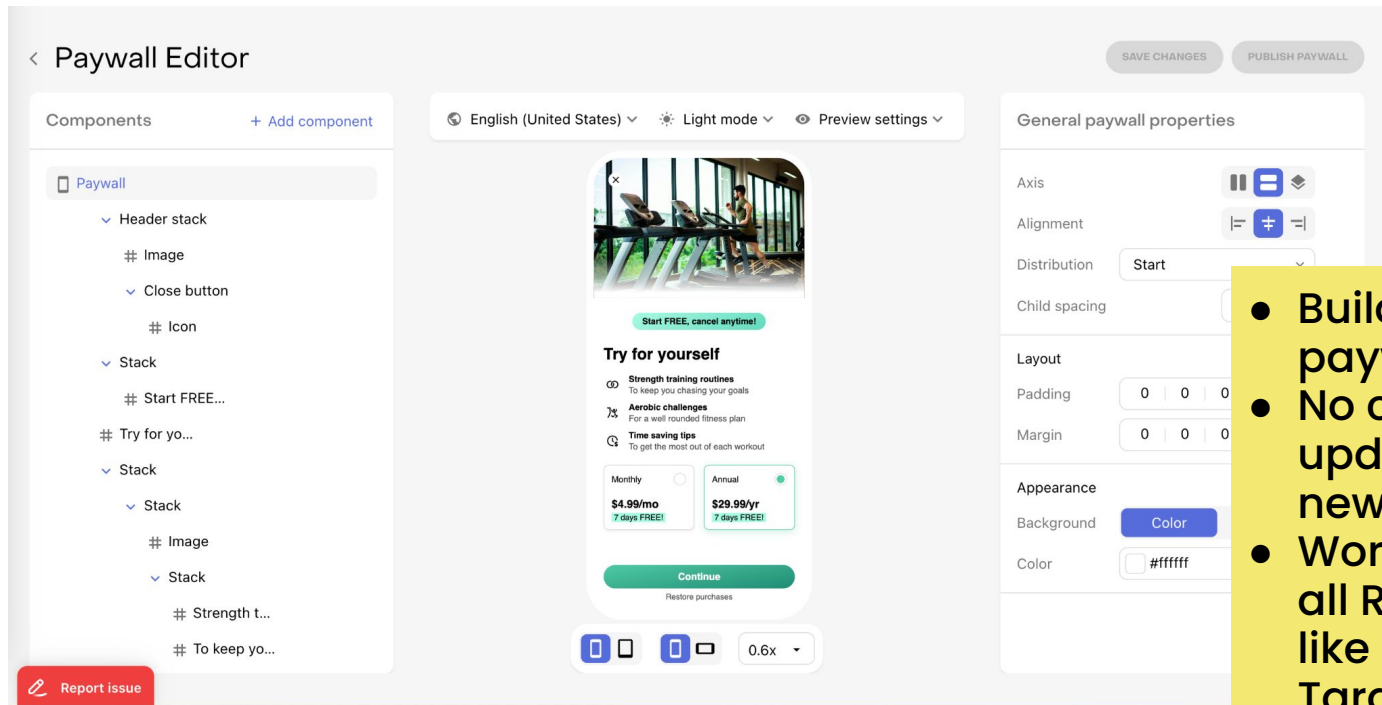
Check out the power of all we off

☐ Monthly \$2.99/wk	☒ Yearly \$35
--	---

Continue

Cancel anytime. Restore

Paywalls – Remotely build and update paywalls



- Build, test and optimize paywalls with ease
- No code required to update or release a new paywall
- Works seamlessly with all RevenueCat tools like Experiments and Targeting

Presenting a paywall

- RevenueCat Paywalls will, by default, show paywalls fullscreen and there are multiple ways to do this with Activities and Jetpack Compose
 - Depending on an entitlement with PaywallDialog
 - Custom logic with PaywallDialog
 - Manually with Paywall, PaywallDialog, or PaywallActivityLauncher

Presenting a paywall

```
@OptIn(ExperimentalPreviewRevenueCatUIPurchasesAPI::class)
class MainActivity : AppCompatActivity(), PaywallResultHandler {
    private lateinit var paywallActivityLauncher: PaywallActivityLauncher
    private lateinit var root: View

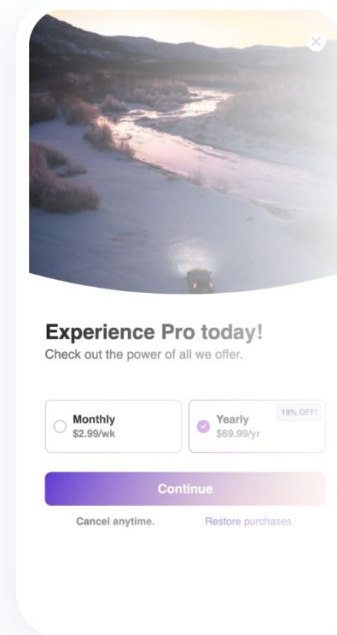
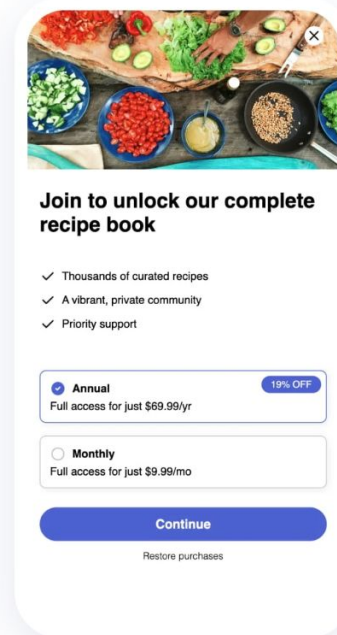
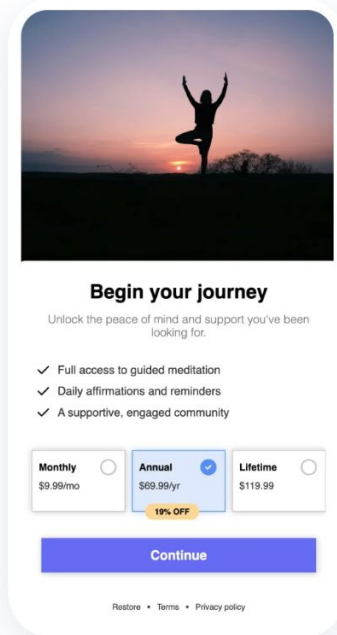
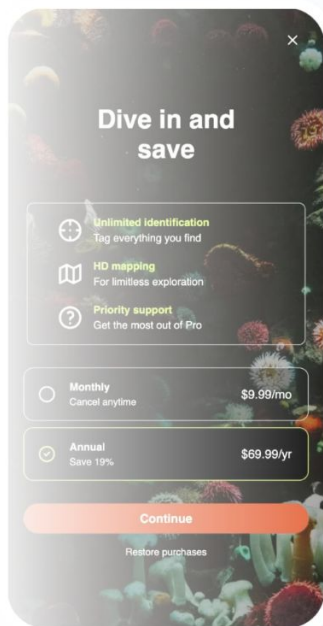
    override fun onCreate(savedInstanceState: Bundle?) {
        super.onCreate(savedInstanceState)

        paywallActivityLauncher = PaywallActivityLauncher(this, this)
    }

    private fun launchPaywallActivity() {
        paywallActivityLauncher.launchIfNeeded(requiredEntitlementIdentifier = Constants.ENTITLEMENT_ID)
    }

    override fun onActivityResult(result: PaywallResult) {}
}
```

Presenting a paywall



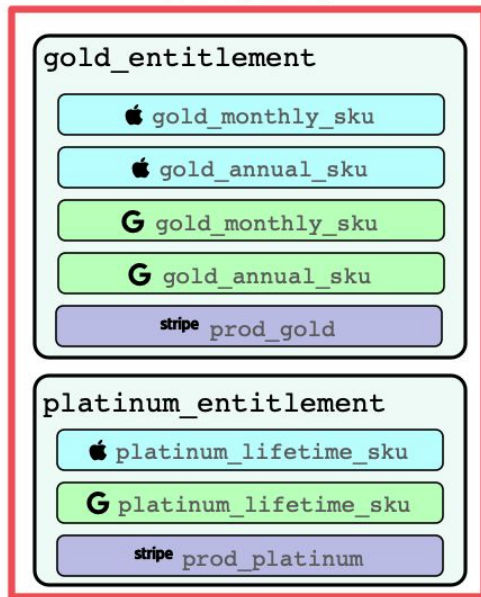
Entitlements

Entitlements Explained

- User buys → entitlement unlocked.
- Represent levels of access/features unlocked by purchases
- Abstract product identifiers from app logic
- One product can unlock multiple entitlements (and vice versa)

RevenueCat Entitlements

(levels of access)



Entitlements Explained

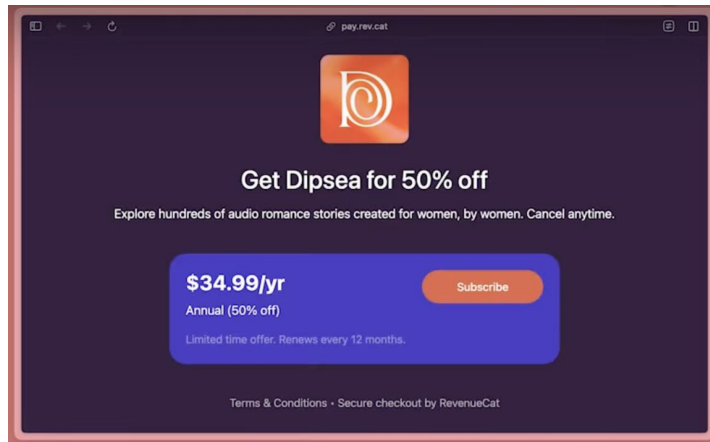
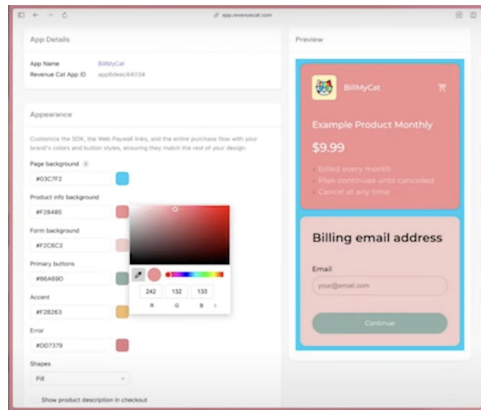
- User buys → entitlement unlocked

```
Purchases.sharedInstance.getCustomerInfoWith(  
    onError = { error -> /* Optional error handling */ },  
    onSuccess = { customerInfo -> /* Access latest customerInfo */ },  
)  
  
// checking customer info for entitlements  
  
if (customerInfo.entitlements[<your_entitlement_id>]?.isActive == true) {  
    // user has access to "your_entitlement_id"  
}
```

Purchasing through web

Web Paywall Links : You customize the design & share the link, we handle everything else .

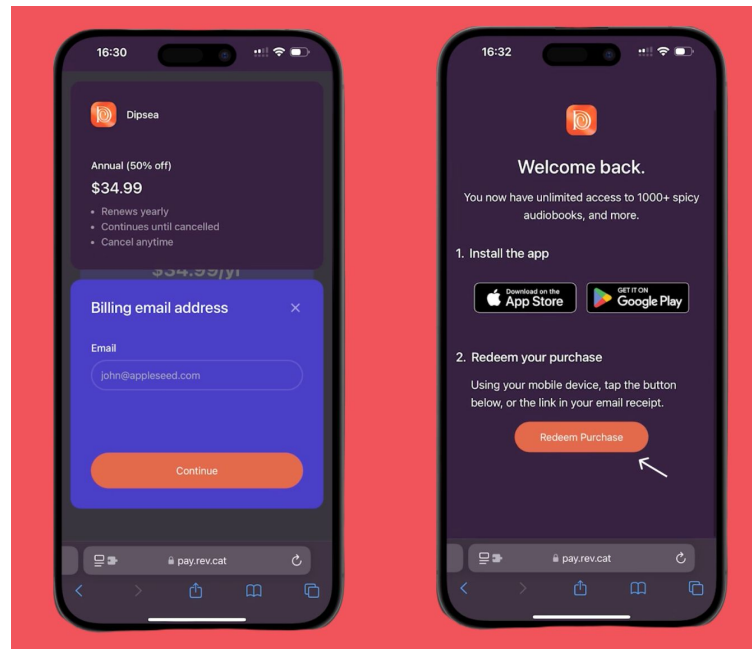
- **You design a no-code web checkout** from the RevenueCat dashboard
- **RevenueCat handles hosting** your web paywall and provides you with a shareable link
- **You share your web paywall link** on your website, via email, social, paid ads or wherever you want.
- **RevenueCat handles** invoicing and provides a customer-facing UI for subscription management



Redemption Links | No login? No problem. Just one click to redeem in app

Eliminate friction and expand to new acquisition channels with a web-to-app experience that can start from anywhere.

1. When a new subscriber completes their purchase from a web paywall they're shown a landing page with **a deep-link to access their content in-app**
2. Simultaneously, they'll receive the same **deep-link via email**
3. When they **click the link on a mobile device** they'll instantly unlock their purchase in your app.



This just in

Google Developer update

- Policy Change (Oct 29, 2025): Updates to Google Play policies for U.S. users.
- More Flexibility: Developers can link to external downloads and use alternative billing methods.
- U.S.-Only: Applies while the court injunction remains in effect.



DEVELOPER UPDATE

Hello Google Play Developer,

We strive to make Google Play a safe and trusted experience for users while exploring ways for developers to introduce new offerings.

Effective October 29, 2025, we're [announcing updates](#) for developers targeting users in the United States to comply with legal obligations in the US. Developers may now lead users in the US to external content including links to downloads and transactions. In addition, we are not requiring the use of Google Play Billing in apps or prohibiting the use of in-app payment methods other than Google Play Billing. Note these changes only apply to users of these apps and games in the US and while the injunction is in effect. These updates supersede any other restrictions in our existing [Payments policy](#) for developers serving users in the US. Please see this [help center article](#) for full details on the changes we are implementing for payments and external links.

Additional details on program requirements and business model will be shared in the near future to ensure that we can do this in a way that preserves user trust and safety in the ecosystem, while we work with the developer and user community on these changes.

Thank you for continuing to partner with us to make Google Play a trustworthy platform for you and your users.



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Or, save 30%

Restore purchases



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Never understood why my cat went crazy at 3 AM until CatGPT explained their behavior patterns. Now we both sleep through the night!

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DAYS

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MONTHS

\$69.99

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LIFETIME

\$119.99

Subscribe now

Join directly and save

Restore Purchases



Get CatGPT Plus

Our most advanced features, for our most dedicated users.

TRY FREE FOR 1 WEEK

- ✓ **Priority access to our advanced feline intelligence**
Skip the queue, get instant cat insights
- ✓ **4x faster response times during peak purring hours**
Never miss a crucial meow-ment
- ✓ **Custom personality matching with 100+ cat breeds**
Find your perfect feline personality match
- ✓ **Unlimited cat-to-human**

Start free trial

Or, start free & save 30%

Auto-renews for \$69.99/year until canceled

Restore Purchases

Terms

Privacy

Recap

Recap

- Monetization is hard but solvable.
- Choose the right model(s) for Android.
- Use RevenueCat to handle complexity.

But most importantly: build apps that are good and monetize in ways that make sense

Monetize your Android app the right way

Perttu Lähteenlahti

